RSE-EXP-01 — Travel & Expense Reimbursement

FICTIONAL — for demonstration only

- Document ID: RSE-EXP-01
- Title: Travel & Expense Reimbursement
- Version: 2026.1
- Effective date: 2026-01-01
- Owner: Finance
- Applies to: all employees
- Status: approved, reviewed 2026-10-15

1 Principles and Scope

Ridgeline reimburses reasonable expenses that are necessary for your work. Choose the cheapest practical option that gets the job done, and spend Ridgeline's money as you would your own. This policy applies to all employees. Limits are per person.

Expenses must be for Ridgeline business, supported by receipts where required, and claimed promptly. Project-related costs should be charged to the right project so they can be billed to the client where the contract allows. If you are unsure whether something is reimbursable, ask your manager or Finance before you spend the money, not after.

2 Before You Travel

2.1 Pre-approval

Your manager pre-approves every business trip before you book it (RSE-LOC-01 §2.1).

2.2 Booking

Book flights, hotels and rental cars through Ridgeline Travel, the internal booking portal, so that bookings follow this policy and Ridgeline knows where you are.

3 Getting There

3.1 Airfare

Book economy class for flights of up to 6 hours. For flights of more than 6 hours you may book premium economy. Business class needs director approval before booking.

Flight time is the scheduled time of the longest flight segment, not the whole journey. Book early where you can, and choose the lowest reasonable fare for your route and times. Seat upgrades, extra legroom and lounge passes paid for without approval are not reimbursed (§7.3).

3.2 Personal car mileage

When you drive your own car on Ridgeline business, for example to a project site, claim mileage at $0.70 per mile. The mileage rate covers fuel and wear; fuel receipts aren't needed for mileage claims.

Claim the business miles only: the distance from your usual workplace or home, whichever is shorter, to the business destination and back. Parking at the destination and road tolls are reimbursed with receipts. Traffic and parking fines are never reimbursed.

3.3 Ground transport

Taxis, ride-share and public buses or trains are reimbursed for business journeys. Rental cars should be compact or intermediate size unless the work needs a larger vehicle.

Decline optional extras such as satellite navigation upgrades, and refuel the car before returning it. Ridgeline's travel insurance covers rental cars booked through Ridgeline Travel, so extra insurance from the rental company isn't needed. Share taxis and cars with colleagues travelling to the same place where practical.

4 Lodging

Hotel lodging is reimbursed up to $250 per night in the US and up to $275 per night outside the US (international), before taxes. Book through Ridgeline Travel.

The nightly limit depends on where you stay, not where you are from: a Denver employee staying in Toronto uses the international limit. If no reasonable hotel is available within the limit, for example during a major event, ask your manager to approve the higher rate before booking and note the approval on your claim. Room service, minibar and in-room entertainment are personal costs.

5 Meals and Entertainment

5.1 Meals

While travelling on business, meals are reimbursed up to $75 per day for domestic travel and up to $90 per day for international travel. Any amount over the daily cap is not reimbursed.

The daily cap covers all your meals that day together, including tips. Domestic means travel within your own country; international means travel outside it. For example, a single dinner costing more than the domestic daily cap on a site visit is reimbursed only up to the cap, and you pay the difference. Meals provided by a client or included in a conference fee are not claimed again.

5.2 Client entertainment

Client entertainment, such as a meal with a client, is reimbursed up to $100 per person and needs your manager's pre-approval.

On your claim, list the people attended, their organisations and the business purpose. Entertainment for public officials needs extra care; check with your manager first. Gifts and hospitality you receive from others are covered by RSE-HB-01 §4.3.

5.3 Alcohol

Alcohol is reimbursed only as part of pre-approved client entertainment.

6 Combining Business and Personal Travel

6.1 Personal days are PTO

Personal days added to a business trip are taken as PTO under the Paid Time Off Policy (RSE-PTO-01).

6.2 Airfare

When you combine business and personal travel, airfare is reimbursed up to the business-only comparison fare, which Ridgeline Travel quotes at booking for the dates the business trip alone would need.

6.3 Personal-day costs

Lodging and meals on personal days are not reimbursed.

For example, if you attend meetings at another office for three days and stay on for a few days of vacation, Ridgeline reimburses lodging and meals for the business days within the limits in §4 and §5.1, and airfare up to the business-only comparison fare. Lodging and meals for the vacation days are yours, and the vacation days are PTO.

7 Other Reimbursable Items

7.1 Safety equipment (PPE)

Field/site-based employees can claim safety equipment (PPE), such as safety boots, safety glasses and high-visibility clothing, up to $300 per year. Other roles cannot claim PPE; site visitors use the site's equipment.

The yearly limit is per calendar year and covers all PPE you claim that year. Claim PPE like any other expense, with the receipt. Equipment must meet the safety standard the site requires; the site safety lead can advise.

7.2 Professional licence renewals

Professional engineering licence renewals are reimbursed.

Claim the renewal fee with the receipt. Fees for licences in additional jurisdictions are reimbursed when your manager agrees they are needed for your projects.

7.3 Not reimbursable

These are not reimbursed: personal travel costs, traffic or parking fines, upgrades without approval, family travel, and personal entertainment.

Personal entertainment includes in-flight films, hotel films, gym fees and sightseeing. Family travel includes the costs of a partner or family members travelling with you, even when they share your room or car.

8 Submitting a Claim

8.1 Receipts

Attach an itemised receipt for every item of $25 or more.

A card statement is not a receipt. Photograph paper receipts and attach them to your claim in the HR Portal. If a receipt is lost, explain on the claim; your manager decides whether to approve it.

8.2 Deadlines

Submit claims within 30 days of the expense. Claims older than 60 days are not reimbursed without a director exception.

Submitting promptly helps projects bill clients accurately and helps Finance close each month. For a long trip, you may submit claims as you go rather than waiting until you return.

8.3 Currency

All limits in this policy are in USD. Claims in other currencies are compared with the limits at the card

rate or Finance's rate on the expense date.

Enter the amount in the currency you paid, and the HR Portal converts it. Card fees for foreign transactions on a personal card are reimbursed if you show them on your statement.

8.4 Who approves

Expense claims are approved by claim total. Your manager approves claims up to $1,000. Your director approves claims up to $5,000. The VP Finance approves claims above $5,000. See also the Approval Matrix (RSE-APR-01 §4). Questions go to Finance at expenses@ridgeline.example.

Approvers check that each item is a genuine business expense, within the limits in this policy and supported by receipts. An approver may approve part of a claim and decline the rest; you will be told which items and why.